

■ AI Around the World

Google Earth Project • Child-friendly information for ages 8–12

Europe, UK and Ireland – AI

Europe, the UK and Ireland are using AI in many different ways, from helping doctors and schools to running businesses and analysing information. AI needs powerful computers called data centres to work. In Ireland, there was **1,743 MW** of data-centre capacity in 2026, using about **8.4 billion units of electricity each year** and producing around **2.13 million tonnes of CO₂**. Data centres also brought benefits, helping create around **9,300 jobs** and adding about **€2.2 billion** to Ireland's economy in 2024. But AI has drawbacks too: data centres need lots of electricity and water, and **40% of people surveyed** said that high energy use was a negative impact. This shows why Europe, the UK and Ireland need to find ways to use AI while also protecting the environment.

Africa

AI is being used across Africa to help doctors find diseases, support farmers with weather and crop information, improve education and provide public services. AI could help countries solve problems more quickly, but access to it is not equal everywhere because some places have limited internet, electricity and digital skills. AI may also change some jobs and could make inequalities bigger if some communities cannot access the technology.

Asia

Asia is a major centre for AI, with the technology being used in factories, hospitals, schools, transport, banking and many other areas. AI can help people and businesses work faster, but it may also change or replace some jobs, especially jobs involving routine tasks. Countries and communities with better technology and skills may benefit more, while others could be left behind.

North and South America

Across North and South America, AI is being used in medicine, education, farming, transport, business, healthcare and public services. Countries such as the United States and Canada are major centres for AI research and companies, while AI is also creating new opportunities across Latin America. However, AI needs powerful computers and data centres, which can use large amounts of electricity and water. There are also concerns about jobs, privacy, false information and unequal access to technology.

Oceania

Australia and other countries in Oceania are using AI in workplaces, schools, healthcare and government services. AI can help people analyse information and complete tasks more quickly. However, its growing use also creates concerns about jobs, misinformation, data security and the large amounts of electricity needed by AI data centres. Countries in the region are looking for ways to use AI while managing these environmental and social impacts.

Antarctica

Antarctica has very little everyday human activity, so AI is mainly used for scientific research. Scientists can use AI to study satellite pictures, track animals, examine ice and understand climate change much faster than humans could on their own. The downside is that the computers used for AI still need

electricity, and scientists must make sure AI gives accurate results when studying this very important environment.